

Helpless

T.S

They took us from the beach-walk in full view of the people, their bullets decimating Robbie. His jaw was bloody and hanging half open as they threw me in the back of the van, my quivering body smashing into Stewart as they sped off with the pair of us.

I felt helpless when they opened the doors to shepherd us into the warehouse. I couldn't hear anything but their spitting, screaming voices.

We were completely alone.

"Where's my cash boy?"

The Boss was quiet, yet his presence cut so much deeper than our kidnapper's threats.

Stew had sounded so smart when he told us that he was gonna start skimming off the top. No-one would notice, why would they question the lack of tenners when they were counting thousands?

And it worked, until those tenners became Rolexes and women and fancy parties.

I guess that's when questions started getting asked.

"You know what, I don't really care about the money."

The Boss clicked his fingers, and out came a jerry can, big, red and yellow nozzle clutched tight. Stew started screaming but it was already shoved down his throat. They took it out quickly and he blubbered petrol.

They kept pouring it over him, through his hair, slathering his shirt, and he dropped to his knees, hands clapping together and spraying the liquid.

"Please."

The Boss looked at me and held out a match.

"You were part of it. Where's your loyalty now?"

My best friend stared at me, tears mixing in with the thick fluid.

I was crying too. But there was no choice here.

I just had to hope they didn't throw me into the flames as well.